



SPECIAL MOMENTS

Scenes from El Celler de Can Roca, illuminated in red for the special event; Josep and Jordi Roca presenting the desserts

What does it mean to eat at the Best Restaurant in the World? To find out, I landed in Barcelona in early December, dodged the Gaudí fans and pickpockets, and boarded a train to Girona—a medieval Catalan city so picturesque it might as well have been designed by Disney. But let's be honest: nobody comes to Girona for its history or architecture. They come for the Roca brothers.

Joan, Josep and Jordi Roca have transformed Girona into a global culinary destination. Their restaurant,

El Celler de Can Roca, doesn't just have three Michelin stars—it's been crowned the World's Best Restaurant twice. Each brother specialises in one part of the dining experience: Joan oversees savoury dishes; Josep curates beverage pairings; while Jordi has mastered the art of pastry. Together, they've built a culinary empire that includes a chocolate factory, a wine bar, and a boutique hotel that feels like Willy Wonka's Spanish vacation home.

I checked into Casa Cacao the evening before my meal, the 15-room boutique hotel in the heart of Girona run by Joan's wife. Understated luxury met artisanal charm, from the rooftop views to the exquisite chocolates left in my room—each detail a testament to the Rocas' meticulous care. The next morning, a visit to Jordi Roca's chocolate factory offered a peek into their philosophy. Ecuadorian cacao beans were transformed into edible art with an almost fanatical dedication to precision, setting the stage perfectly for the meal to come.

But this was no ordinary meal at El Celler. I had come for a one-day-only collaboration between the Roca brothers and The Macallan, the legendary Scotch